

August 24, 2026

Dear Yelp Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Entry Level Data Backend Engineer - Trust & Safety position at Yelp. With a Master of Science in Computer Science from the University of Calgary and hands-on experience building Python/C++ data-processing systems, backend APIs, SQL-backed services, and scalable research software, I am excited by the chance to help build systems that keep Yelp trustworthy for millions of users.

What draws me to this role is its practical mix of backend engineering, data pipelines, internal tooling, and ML collaboration. Yelp's Content Safety team works on enforcement pipelines and tooling that need to be reliable, understandable, and fast enough to support real-time decisions. That matches the kind of engineering I enjoy: building clean software around messy data, debugging carefully, and making technical systems usable for the people who depend on them.

As a Research Software Developer with BigGeo/Mitacs at the University of Calgary, I built Python and C++ systems for processing, storing, retrieving, and evaluating large Earth observation datasets. I developed repeatable pipelines, automated satellite-imagery preprocessing, converted data into structured tensor files, and improved one encoding workflow from 233 seconds to 26 seconds using C++ multithreading. This work strengthened my ability to reason about data structures, scalability, data quality, performance, and reliability in high-volume data systems.

I also bring backend and database experience from my work as a Back-End Developer, where I designed and implemented Django REST APIs backed by PostgreSQL, built authentication workflows, integrated payment-service logic, and contributed to a WebRTC-based chatbot system using GPT-style responses and FAQ data. Through teaching assistant roles, I supported students with AWS-based data pipelines, cloud storage, large-scale data processing, SQL, debugging, and database coursework.

I have not yet worked on a production Trust & Safety enforcement stack or on-call rotation, but I bring the core foundations Yelp asks for: strong Python, SQL familiarity, algorithms and data structures, backend service development, data pipeline experience, clear communication, and a habit of asking precise questions when ramping into unfamiliar systems. My ML background would also help me collaborate effectively with ML engineers on detection signals and model outputs.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my Python, backend, data pipeline, debugging, and ML-adjacent software experience can contribute to Yelp's Content Safety team.

Sincerely,

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